Senior Technical Architect Take-Home Assessment FAQ

1. How much time should I spend?

A strong submission typically requires 10–14 hours of focused work.

The assignment is intentionally larger than what comfortably fits within the time budget. We do not expect complete coverage.

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2. Do I need to finish everything?

No.

We value prioritization, depth, and reasoning more than attempting to complete everything.

If you run out of time, clearly document:

- What you completed
- Where you stopped
- What you would do next

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3. Is Node.js mandatory?

No.

Node.js / TypeScript is preferred, but you may use any stack that allows you to move fastest.

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4. Which database should I use?

Your choice.

We are more interested in your design decisions than the specific technologies selected.

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5. Can I use ChatGPT, Claude, Cursor, Copilot, Google, Stack Overflow, or official documentation?

Yes.

We assume candidates will use available tools and resources.

The discussion round focuses on understanding your reasoning and decisions.

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6. Do I need to implement all three parts?

No.

Part A (Architecture) is the most important section.

Part B (Architecture Review) and Part C (Implementation Slice) allow you to differentiate yourself.

7. Is UI development required?

No.

Backend services, architecture, and correctness are significantly more important than UI.

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8. Do I need to build a complete product?

No.

For Part C, we expect a thin vertical slice that demonstrates your approach to solving the hardest or riskiest part of the system.

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9. Is Docker required?

Yes.

Your runnable solution should work using:

docker compose up

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10. Is Terraform mandatory?

Infrastructure as Code is expected.

Terraform or an equivalent approach is acceptable.

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11. Do I need cloud accounts?

No.

Local execution is sufficient.

LocalStack or equivalent approaches are acceptable.

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12. Are the provided datasets production-sized?

No.

The sample data is a pilot dataset intended for validation.

Architectural decisions should be made with production scale in mind.

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13. Do I need EV charging domain knowledge?

No.

Prior experience in EV charging systems is not required.

We are evaluating engineering judgment and architectural thinking rather than domain expertise.

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14. Can I ask questions?

Yes.

Please reply to the invitation email with your questions.

We prefer answering in writing so that clarifications remain unambiguous.

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15. What happens after submission?

Shortlisted candidates will participate in a 75–90 minute technical discussion.

This discussion focuses on:

- Architecture decisions
- Trade-offs
- Failure scenarios
- Code review
- Design extensions

The goal is to understand your approach and depth rather than memorized answers.

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16. What are you evaluating?

We are primarily evaluating:

- Architecture and system design
- Technical leadership
- Prioritization and trade-offs
- Distributed systems thinking
- Failure handling and correctness
- Communication and reasoning
- Engineering execution

Completeness is less important than thoughtful decisions and clear explanations.